INTERPERSONAL FALSE BELIEF #18 · RELATIVES

“I'm the black sheep, and I'll never belong.”

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Where it often comes from

In many families, one person ends up as the odd one out: the one who thinks differently, left the faith, made a different choice, or was blamed for the family’s problems. Years of being misunderstood, teased, or excluded can harden into the belief that we will never belong anywhere.

What Scripture teaches

Scripture says, “God settles the lonely in families.” John writes, “to all who did receive Him, to those who believed in His name, He gave the right to become children of God.” Paul says, “You received the Spirit of sonship… The Spirit Himself testifies with our spirit that we are God’s children.” Jesus said, “For whoever does the will of God is My brother and sister and mother.” Even if your family of origin has never made room for you, you have a place in God’s family, and He can provide people who welcome you.

> *“God settles the lonely in families; He leads the prisoners out to prosperity, but the rebellious dwell in a sun-scorched land”* (Psalm 68:6).

Also see

> “But to all who did receive Him, to those who believed in His name, He gave the right to become children of God” (John 1:12).

> “For you did not receive a spirit of slavery that returns you to fear, but you received the Spirit of sonship, by whom we cry, ‘Abba! Father!’ The Spirit Himself testifies with our spirit that we are God’s children” (Romans 8:15–16).

> “For whoever does the will of God is My brother and sister and mother” (Mark 3:35).

> “Therefore you are no longer strangers and foreigners, but fellow citizens with the saints and members of God’s household” (Ephesians 2:19).

Common self-statements

- I will always be the outsider.
- They never understood me.
- There is something wrong with me.
- I do not belong in any family.
- I am the problem.
- Nobody will ever make room for me.

Common logical errors

- Labeling: Calling myself “the black sheep.”
- Overgeneralizing: Treating one family’s rejection as universal.
- Personalization: Assuming I was the cause of the family’s difficulties.
- Fortune telling: Predicting that I will never belong.

Challenging questions

- How did I come to be the odd one out in my family?

- Whose problems got pinned on me?
- In what ways might my differences be strengths?
- Where do I feel welcome, and what do those places have in common?
- What does God say about my place in His family?
- What community could I invest in this month?

Truth summary

> Being the odd one out in my family does not decide where I belong. God has made me His child, and He settles the lonely in families. I can find and build a family of faith and friendship who welcome me.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Loneliness
- Church
- Friendship
- Self-Esteem, Low
- Love, By God

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Self-Esteem, Low
- Love

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

I Am Not Alone — Kari Jobe
God's companionship remains through darkness, weakness, and uncertainty.

The God Who Stays — Matthew West
God's faithful presence challenges the expectation of rejection and abandonment.

If We Are the Body — Casting Crowns
The church is called to welcome and care for people rather than exclude or shame them.

Softly and Tenderly — Kristyn Getty with Vince Gill, Ellie Holcomb and Sierra Hull
This older hymn pictures Christ's gracious invitation to return rather than hide in shame.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "I'm the black sheep, and I'll never belong"

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Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"I'm the black sheep, and I'll never belong." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ How did I become the odd one out?
- ☐ What strengths do my differences bring?
- ☐ Where am I welcome?
- ☐ What does God say about my place?
- ☐ What group could I join?
- ☐ Who can I talk with?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ God settles the lonely in families.
- ☐ I have the right to be a child of God.
- ☐ The Spirit testifies that I belong.
- ☐ I am part of Christ's family.
- ☐ My differences are not a defect.
- ☐ I can build a community.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ Psalm 68:6
  "God settles the lonely in families; He leads the prisoners out to prosperity, but the rebellious dwell in a sun-scorched land."
- ☐ John 1:12
  "But to all who did receive Him, to those who believed in His name, He gave the right to become children of God."
- ☐ Mark 3:35
  "For whoever does the will of God is My brother and sister and mother."

A verse I found myself: _____

Practicing the Truth

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5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] Where I belong: Each week, note one place or person where you felt welcome.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Psalm 68:6 becomes: "Sarah can write: "God settles the lonely in families, and that includes me.""
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Loneliness" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

Choose steps you can do safely. If there is violence, coercion, or fear of retaliation, seek private professional support before trying anything with the other person. In an emergency call 911.

- [ ] Name the role. Write how you became "the black sheep" and whose idea it was.
- [ ] List your strengths. Write what makes you different and valuable.
- [ ] Join a group. Commit to a church group, class, or team for a few weeks.
- [ ] Read Psalm 68:5–6. Say it as a prayer.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "I'm the black sheep, and I'll never belong": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	A place I belong
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~I'm the black sheep, and I'll never belong.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, You settle the lonely in families. I have felt like an outsider for so long. Show me my place in Your family, and lead me to people who welcome me. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.